A CRM APPLICATION FOR THE CHAI SHOP & CO

3. PROJECT DESIGN PHASE

3.1 Problem-Solution Fit

The project addresses manual tea shop operations by replacing fragmented paper-based records and disconnected spreadsheets with centralized CRM management. The design aims to reduce data loss, minimize entry errors, improve customer, order and inventory tracking, speed up reporting, and support real-time visibility of Chai Shop & Co. business information.

3.2 Proposed Solution

Aspect	Design
Problem	Manual maintenance can cause errors, stock mismatches, data loss and delays in sales and customer reporting.
Solution	A Salesforce-based CRM Application for the Chai Shop & Co. with centralized records and controlled access.
Innovation	Structured CRM records, validation, cloud storage, automated processes and real-time reporting.
Impact	Improved information accuracy, faster customer and order tracking, and better data-driven decisions.
Business Model	Digital CRM and tea shop management platform for customer, product, order and inventory information.
Scalability	Can support multiple shop locations, users, products and customers as the organization grows.

3.3 Four-Layer Architecture

Layer	Components	Purpose
1. Presentation	Salesforce Lightning UI	Provides screens for users to create, view and manage customer, product, order and inventory records.
2. Application	Validation Rules, Relationships and Automation	Applies business rules and connects related records.

3. Data	Customer, Product, Order and Inventory custom objects	Stores structured Chai Shop & Co. CRM data in Salesforce Cloud.

4. Analytics	Reports and Dashboards	Converts stored CRM, sales and inventory data into operational and management insights.

3.4 Object and Relationship Design

- Customer is connected to Order through a Lookup relationship to maintain customer order history.
- Order is connected to Product through an Order Line/related-record structure for recording purchased items.
- Product is connected to Inventory to maintain stock quantities and availability.
- The design keeps customer, product, order and inventory information organized into logical CRM objects instead of one large record.

3.5 Design Goals

- Centralize Chai Shop & Co. CRM records.
- Reduce duplicate, missing and invalid data.
- Provide controlled access for authorized users.
- Make customer, sales and inventory information easy to report and visualize.
- Improve order processing and stock monitoring.
- Create a scalable CRM structure for future features such as AI-based insights and automated customer engagement.